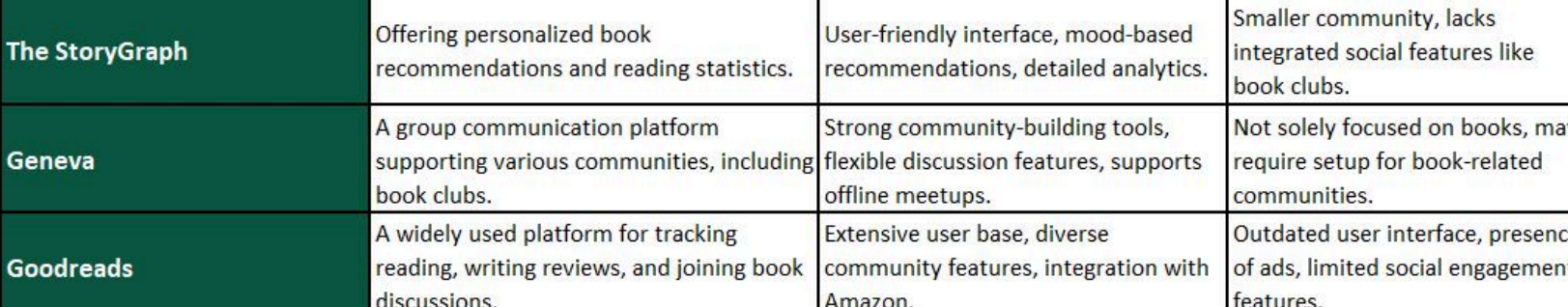


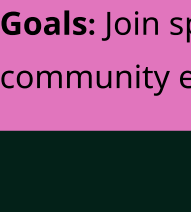
Hi! My name is Astha. If there is anything one can say with utmost certainty, it is the fact that I love to read. When I was choosing companies I would want to create a Product Teardown on, it was a no-brainer that Fable had to be one of them. Below are some things that I absolutely love about Fable, and some things that I wish, as a user, were changed. I really hope you give it a read!

MISSION : Become the world's best mobile service for curated reading; where people can share in private groups and creators can self-publish.

AIM : Identify areas of improvement in the current application and suggest some new features that can be incorporated in the application



Competitor	Description	Strengths	Weaknesses
The StoryGraph	Offering personalized book recommendations and reading statistics.	User-friendly interface, mood-based recommendations, detailed analytics.	Smaller community, lacks integrated social features like book clubs.
Geneva	A group communication platform supporting various communities, including book clubs.	Strong community-building tools, flexible discussion features, supports offline meetups.	Not solely focused on books, may require setup for book-related communities.
Goodreads	A widely used platform for tracking reading, writing reviews, and joining book discussions.	Extensive user base, diverse community features, integration with Amazon.	Dated user interface, presence of ads, limited social engagement features.
Wattpad	A platform where users can read and write original stories across various genres.	Large, engaged community; strong discoverability for new writers; potential for book deals.	Quality control issues; not focused on traditional books or book discussions.
AO3 (Archive of Our Own)	A nonprofit platform for fanfiction and original works.	No ads, extensive tagging system, strong fan community.	No official publishing or book club features, limited mainstream book discussions.



Rachael Green, 25
Software Engineer
"After staring at the computer screen all day, I want to do something away from screen."

Motivations: Seeking a community to discuss and explore books, discover new titles, and share reviews.

Frustrations: Limited local book clubs, desire for deeper discussions beyond surface-level reviews.

Goals: Engage in meaningful conversations about books, find personalized recommendations, and track reading progress.

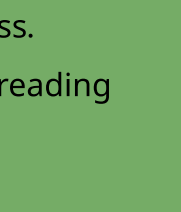


Evan Anthony, 27
Social Media Marketer
"My creative inspiration mostly comes from watching different kinds of series!"

Motivations: Discuss popular TV shows, share theories, and connect with others who have similar viewing interests.

Frustrations: Spoilers on social media, lack of dedicated platforms for in-depth TV show discussions.

Goals: Join spoiler-free discussion rooms, receive updates on favorite shows, and participate in community events.

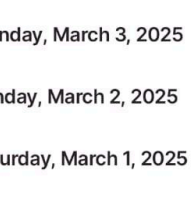


Ariel Totemham, 26
Author
"I want to shape the world, one book at a time!"

Motivations: Share their work, receive constructive criticism, and build a reader base.

Frustrations: Limited platforms for new authors, difficulty reaching target audiences, and lack of feedback.

Goals: Engage with readers, participate in discussions to understand audience preferences, and promote their writings.



Rakhi Sharma, 24
Founder of an EdTech Firm
"My work is very stressful, I want build a habit of reading everyday to unwind."

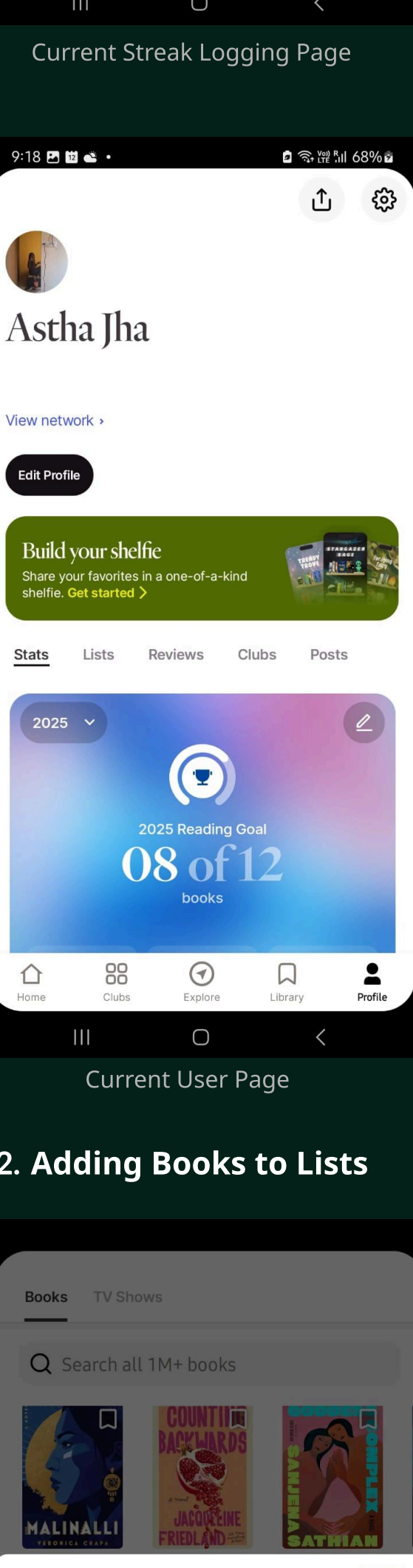
Motivations: Use reading as a tool for relaxation, stress reduction, and personal growth.

Frustrations: Overwhelmed by a daily stressors, seeking constructive outlets for mental wellness.

Goals: Explore curated book recommendations focused on mental wellness and make use of reading challenges, and streaks to start reading.

1. Streak Logging and it's Placement

Metrics targeted: Increase in stickiness, DAU and reading session duration/frequency



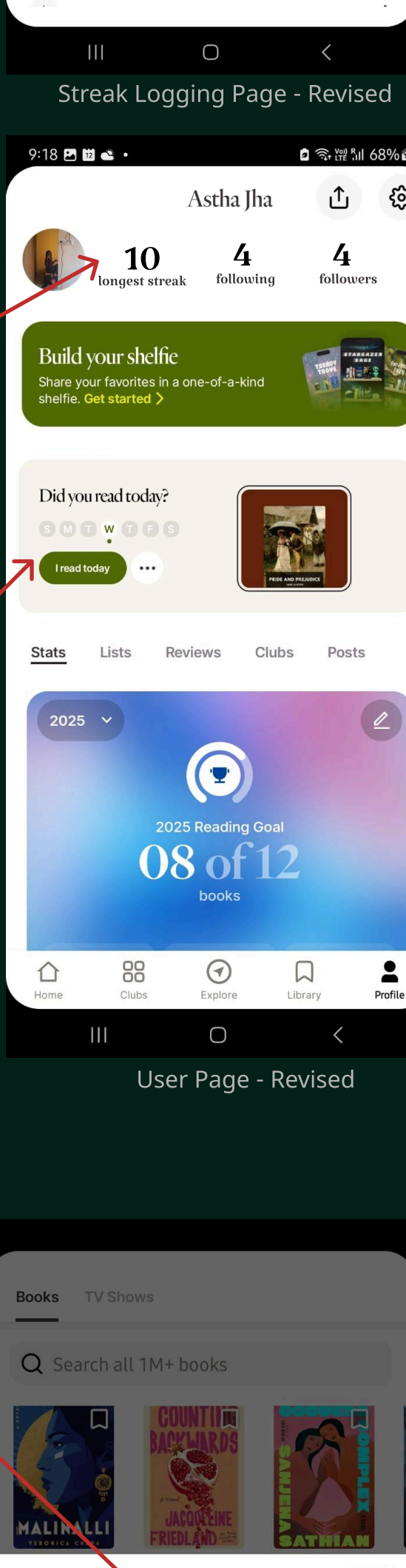
Current Streak Logging Page

While this version of streak logging does it's job, a more intuitive version would be a calendar view, with the current date auto selected.

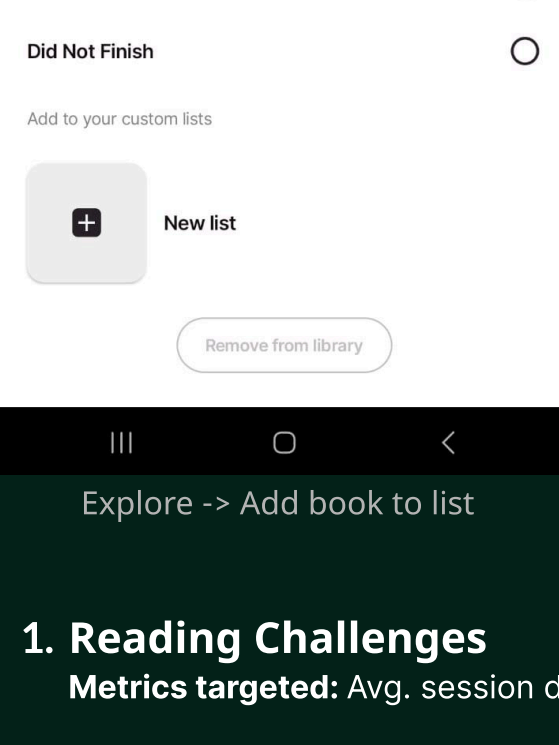
fun fact: A calendar view taps into the Zeigarnik effect — humans dislike incomplete patterns, so they're motivated to complete a streak.

A green outline can be shown around for days when a user has entered a streak. If the user wishes to enter streak on another day, they have to click on that date, and it redirects them to the "choose book" page, and it turns green.

To deselect, all that should be required is tapping the date again.



Streak Logging Page - Revised

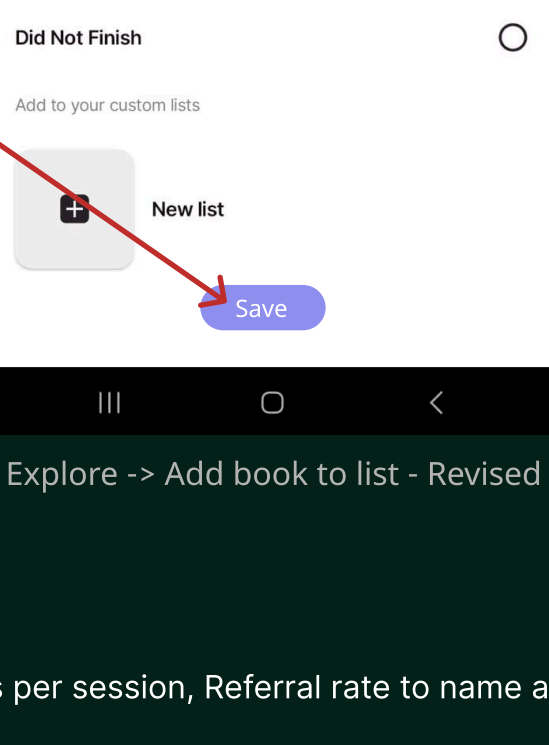


Current User Page

Instead of "View Network" that leads to following and followers, why not have that metric shown clearly on the user page?

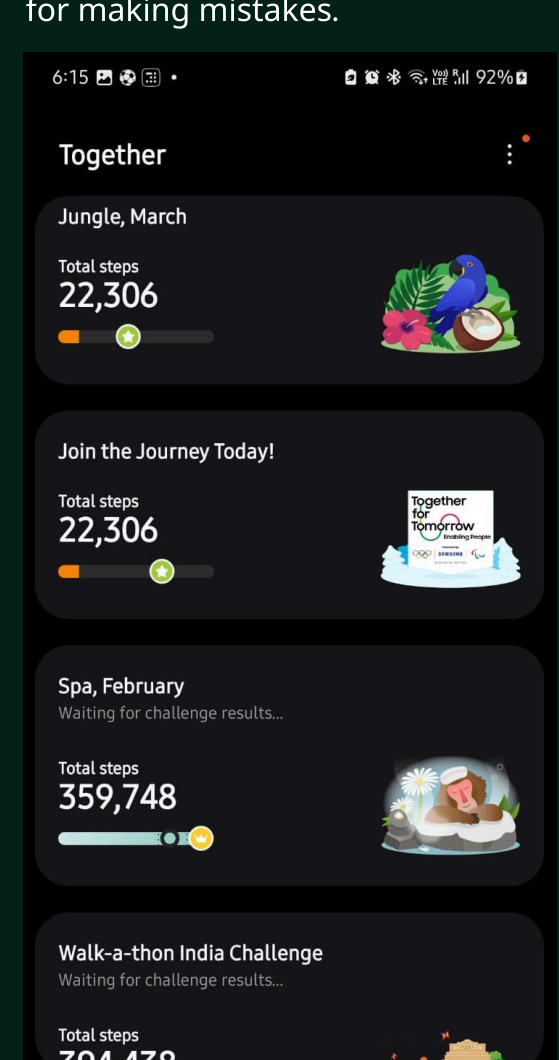
I have used "Longest Streak" as the additional metric, that can be switched with "Lifetime Books", "Total Reading Time", "Total Pages Read" - to name a few.

Additionally, the streak logging can be moved to the user page. It segregates all the user related data from the chaos of unrelated information.



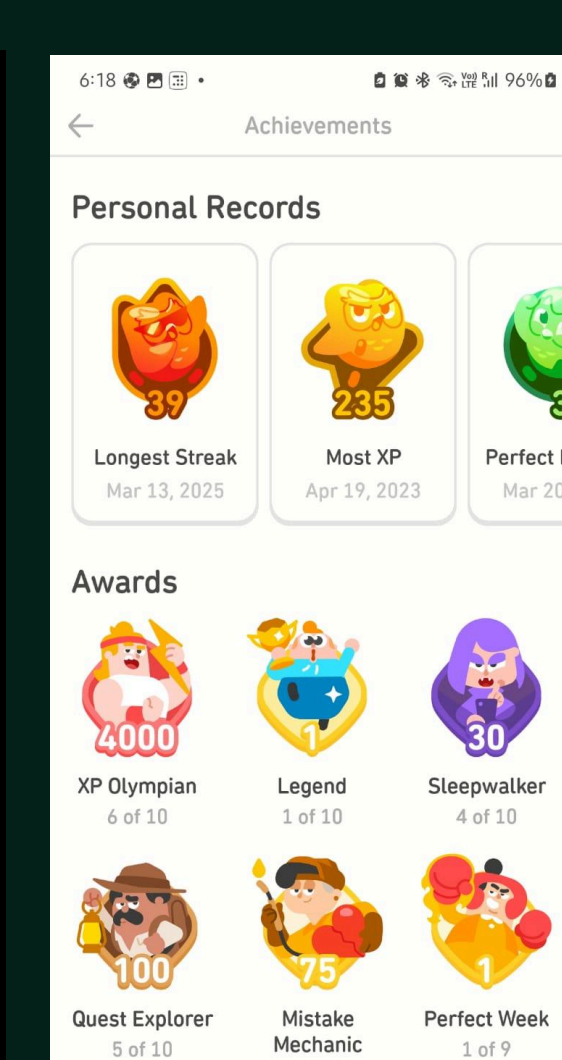
User Page - Revised

2. Adding Books to Lists



Explore -> Add book to list

- Add the "Book Name" to ensure user knows they've clicked on the correct book.
- To "Remove from Library" a simple click on the radio button again should do the trick.
- The "Remove from library" button is more often confused with "Save" because of it's placement. Since this page has a vertical decision making approach, the "Save" button should ideally be placed on the bottom of the page.

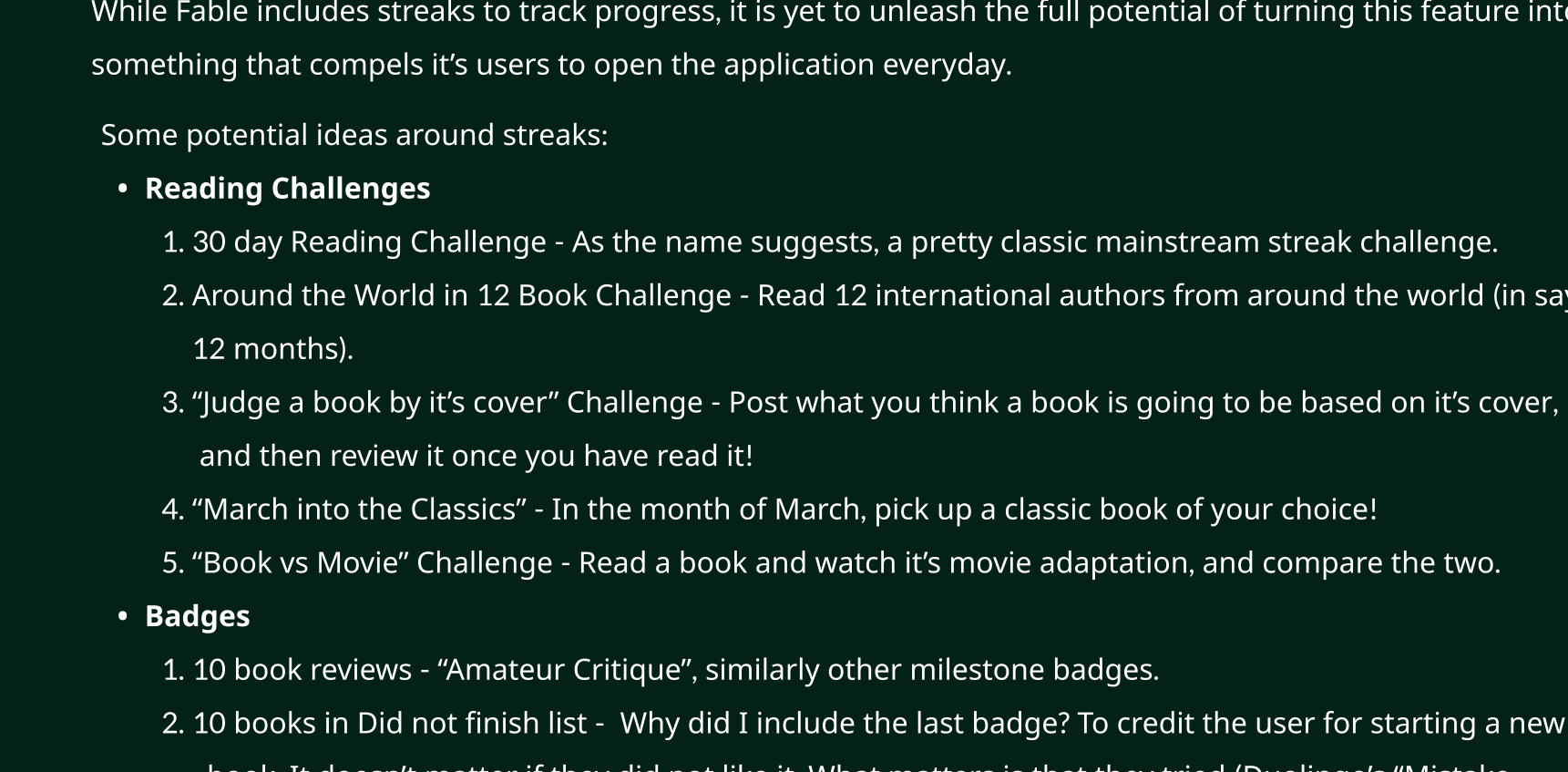


Explore -> Add book to list - Revised

1. Reading Challenges

Metrics targeted: Avg. session duration, Sessions per user, Page views per session, Referral rate to name a few)

One of the best ways to foster a community and inculcate new habits is to give them a way to bond. For example, Samsung Health, a basic healthcare application, sees over 300,000 MaU with their monthly walking challenges and subsequent leader boards. Duolingo, just like Fable, uses streaks to inculcate the habit of learning a new language. The catch? The excellent animation used to showcase increase in streak number, badges for personal accomplishments, and witty notifications increase the user retention rate. Please note, for later reference, how Duolingo has a "Mistake Mechanic" badge. It encourages users to correct their mistake in their lessons, and gives them badges for making mistakes.



Different walking challenges available on Samsung Health Badges (Samsung Health) Badges (Duolingo)

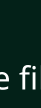
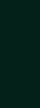
While Fable includes streaks to track progress, it is yet to unleash the full potential of turning this feature into something that compels it's users to open the application everyday.

- Some potential ideas around streaks:
- **Total Challenges**
 1. 30 day Reading Challenge - As the name suggests, a pretty classic mainstream streak challenge.
 2. Around the World in 12 Book Challenge - Read 12 international authors from around the world (in say, 12 months).
 3. "Judge a book by it's cover" Challenge - Post what you think a book is going to be based on it's cover, and then review it once you have read it!
 4. "March into the Classics" - In the month of March, pick up a classic book of your choice!
 5. "Book vs Movie" Challenge - Read a book and watch it's movie adaptation, and compare the two.
 - **Badges**
 1. 10 book reviews - "Amateur Critique", similarly other milestone badges.
 2. 10 books in Did not finish list - Why did I include the last badge? To credit the user for starting a new book. It doesn't matter if they did not like it. What matters is that they tried (Duolingo's "Mistake Mechanic" badge reference!)

2. Wrapped

Metrics targeted: Yearly retention, Referral Rate, LTV - Long Term, Virality Coefficient

A basic version of "Wrapped" is already implemented, in the form of Monthly Wrapped. While there is no one who can ever convince me against Wrapped, I do believe a bi-yearly or yearly wrapped makes more sense. Realistically, people read a median of 4 books in a year. If we look at a country-wise data:

5 Countries that Read the Most Books				
 United States	 India	 United Kingd...	 France	 Italy
17 books	16 books	15 books	14 books	13 books

Source: World Population Review, 2024

The above data shows that a person reads less than 2 books monthly. Thus, the monthly wrapped looks rather empty (speaking from personal experience here). Instead, if we look at bi-yearly or yearly wrapped, some metrics that we can use are:

- Total Books Read
- Most Read - Author
- Most Read - Genre
- Best Reading Streak
- Highest Page Count
- Line graph of Number of Books Read of the Year
- Line chart of Books Comparison of Last Year v/s Current Year (once enough data is present), etc.

The same data can be analyzed for people who log television series and movies.

Finally, instead of 'Wrapped', the team can use unique names. "Fable Footprints", or "Chronicles of <year>" are just some examples.

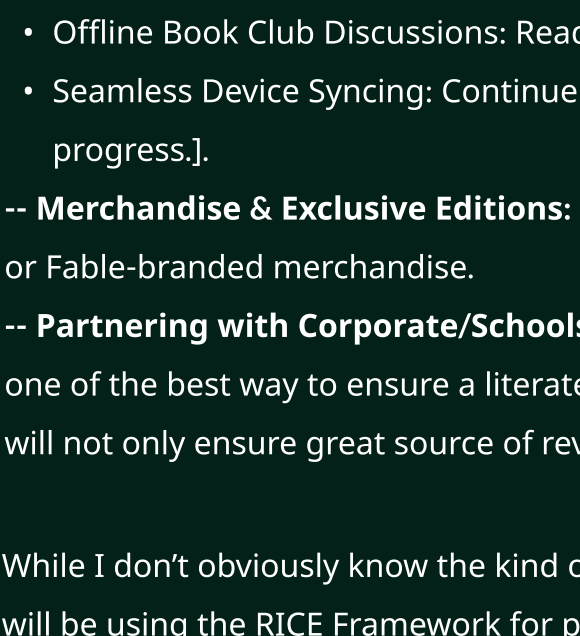
3. Genre Filters

Metrics targeted: Search Engagement Rate, NPS Rate, Less Drop off Rate at Search.

Users should be able to filter Books and Movies based on their genres. As an avid reader and binge watcher, I usually search books and series up based on my mood. Am I in the mood for a thriller? Do I want a romantic comedy? Or do I want a knight in shining armor coming and saving his princess? A genre based filtering will make things easy.

There are several ways to implement this feature. One of the major requirements to implementing this feature is tagging the genre of the book in your database. Post that, let users search a genre, and let the results show.

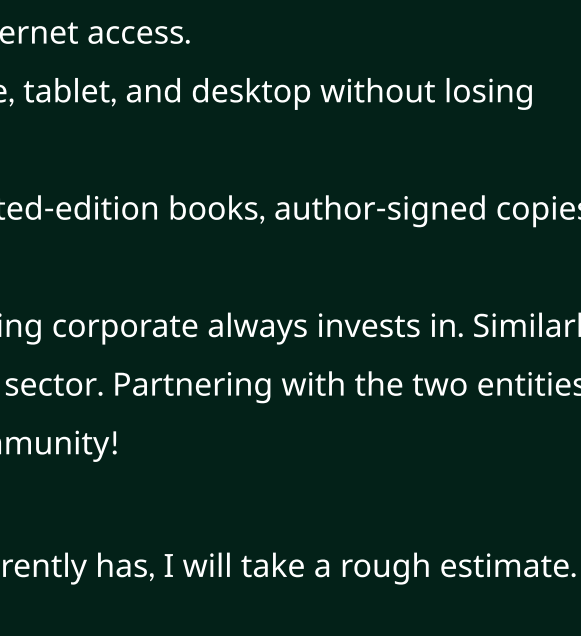
Another method would be a simple "Filter" button which contains different genres present. The user can click their interested ones, and select "Apply".



explore page - revised

Once the filter button is clicked, it leads to a page, or a container that lets users filter out books based on different parameter like genre.

Container, or page that leads to filtering options.



explore page - filter section

P.S. - I am not a designer, hence consider this more of a wireframe than anything else!

Fable currently sustains via:

1. Affiliate & Direct Book Sales - Fable likely earns a cut from book purchases made through the app.
2. Partnerships & Licensing - Collaborations with authors, publishers.

In the future, it will have to look into monetizing itself via other channels as well! Some other methods could be:

- **Exclusive Book Clubs & Author Access:**
 - VIP Book Clubs: Access to private, invite-only clubs led by experts or celebrities.
 - Author Q&A Sessions: Live chats, AMAs, or video discussions with authors.
 - Curated Reading Paths: Step-by-step reading guides by industry experts, helping users explore books around specific themes (e.g., "Mastering Productivity," "Feminist Literature," etc.).
- **Enhanced Reading & Discussion Tools:**
 - Voice Notes & Personalized Annotations: Users can record audio reflections or add detailed annotations to share in book clubs.
 - Share Quote Feature: This is something that I first saw in a similar app, Wattpad, where users could save/ share quotes from a specific book in an image format, with varied backgrounds, fonts, etc.
- **Gamification & Engagement Features:**
 - Reading Streaks & Achievements: Users get badges and rewards for consistent reading.
 - Discussion Leaderboards: Recognizing top contributors in book clubs.
 - Customizable Profile & Book Stats: Premium users can track detailed stats on their reading habits (genres read, time spent, fastest completion, etc.).
- **Offline & Multi-Device Access:**
 - **Offline Book Discussions:** Read and discuss without needing internet access.
 - Seamless Device Syncing: Continue reading/discussing across mobile, tablet, and desktop without losing progress.
- **Merchandise & Exclusive Editions:** Premium users get access to limited-edition books, author-signed copies, or Fable-branded merchandise.
- **Partnering with Corporate/Schools:** Wellness programs are something corporate always invests in. Similarly, one of the best way to ensure a literate crowd is entering the education sector. Partnering with the two entities will not only ensure a source of revenue, but also foster a great community!

While I don't obviously know the kind of resources the team at Fable currently has, I will take a rough estimate. I will be using the RICE Framework for prioritizing features.

Feature	Reach (1-10)	Impact (1-5)	Confidence (1-100%)	Effort (1-10)	RICE Score
1. Reading Challenges & Badges	8	4	90%	5	57.6
2. Yearly/Bi-Yearly Wrapped ("Fable Footprints")	7	3	85%	4	44.6
3. Genre-Based Filtering for Books & Movies	9	5	95%	6	71.3
4. Streak Logging Change - Calendar View	6	3	80%	4	36
5. Improved User Page UI (More Metrics, Network Display)	5	3	75%	3	37.5

Prioritization Order (Highest to Lowest RICE Score)

1. **Genre-Based Filtering (71.3)** → High engagement, improves search & discovery.
2. **Reading Challenges & Badges (57.6)** → Strong retention & habit formation.
3. **Yearly/Bi-Yearly Wrapped (44.6)** → Engagement boost, but needs data history.
4. **Improved User Page UI (37.5)** → Enhances UX & personalization, moderate effort.
5. **Calendar View for Streak Logging (36.0)** → Better usability, but limited reach.

Hi, I am Astha Jha, a 2024 Bachelors of Technology graduate, with a major in Information Technology from VIT, Vellore (#9 in India)! I am an avid reader. I have been eating, sleeping and breathing books since the mere age of 10. I pursued engineering because I loved to create new things. I replicated (a rather lousy version) of my school's website when I was 12, and never looked back!

It was when I joined university, I first managed a product from it's ideation to marketing. When one of the products under my team touch 33K users on the PlayStore, I realized this industry offered a lot more than my tunneled vision was seeing. I eventually ended up handling content, marketing and cross-team communication between Design, Management and Technical teams at my technical chapter, Google Developer Students Club, in my university.

I hope you liked this teardown, as much as I enjoyed making it. I am open to any feedback that you might have!)

Astha Jha
asthajha05@gmail.com